

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12414795
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 16, 2025
Inventor(s)	Kitaoka; Takashi et al.

Medical device, method for controlling rotation of medical device, and rotation controller

Abstract

A medical device is disclosed that can effectively destroy an object in a biological lumen, a method for controlling rotation of the medical device, and a rotation controller. The medical device to be inserted into a biological lumen to destroy a thrombus in the biological lumen includes an elongated shaft portion that is rotationally driven, a drive unit that rotates the shaft portion, a breaking member that is provided at a distal portion of the shaft portion and is rotatable, and a control unit that controls the rotation of the drive unit, in which the control unit controls the drive unit to repeat the rotation while interposing a stop of the rotation between rotations of the drive unit.

Inventors: Kitaoka; Takashi (Hadano, JP), Imai; Masaomi (Kofu, JP), Kanamoto; Kazuaki (Hadano, JP), Masubuchi; Yuki (Hadano, JP)

Applicant: TERUMO KABUSHIKI KAISHA (Tokyo, JP)

Family ID: 1000008821002

Assignee: TERUMO KABUSHIKI KAISHA (Tokyo, JP)

Appl. No.: 18/500578

Filed: November 02, 2023

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240058030 A1	Feb. 22, 2024

Foreign Application Priority Data

JP	2017-194059	Oct. 04, 2017
----	-------------	---------------

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 16831029 20200326 US 11826072 child-doc US 18500578
continuation parent-doc WO PCT/JP2018/035315 20180925 PENDING child-doc US 16831029

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: A61B17/3207 (20060101); A61B17/00 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC A61B17/320758 (20130101); A61B17/320725 (20130101); A61B2017/00398 (20130101); A61B2017/00867 (20130101); A61B2017/320733 (20130101); A61B2217/005 (20130101)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: A61B (17/320725); A61B (17/320758); A61B (2017/00398); A61B (2017/00867); A61B (2017/320733)

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
5766191	12/1997	Trerotola	N/A	N/A
2002/0165567	12/2001	Shiber	N/A	N/A
2007/0208370	12/2006	Hauser	606/200	A61B 17/225
2007/0239140	12/2006	Chechelski et al.	N/A	N/A
2012/0130410	12/2011	Tal et al.	N/A	N/A
2014/0207052	12/2013	Tal et al.	N/A	N/A
2015/0164541	12/2014	Shiber	N/A	N/A
2016/0120570	12/2015	Kobayashi et al.	N/A	N/A
2016/0270813	12/2015	Chida	N/A	N/A
2016/0278805	12/2015	Hatta et al.	N/A	N/A
2017/0224364	12/2016	Imai et al.	N/A	N/A
2017/0238960	12/2016	Hatta et al.	N/A	N/A
2017/0252058	12/2016	Bar-cohen et al.	N/A	N/A
2019/0000500	12/2018	Masubuchi et al.	N/A	N/A
2019/0175212	12/2018	Kitaoka et al.	N/A	N/A
2020/0222076	12/2019	Kitaoka et al.	N/A	N/A

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
203841754	12/2013	CN	N/A
105310745	12/2015	CN	N/A
2017151178	12/2016	WO	N/A
2017154749	12/2016	WO	N/A
2017154909	12/2016	WO	N/A
2018038017	12/2017	WO	N/A

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

Office Action (The First Office Action) issued Nov. 3, 2022, by the State Intellectual Property Office of People's Republic of China in corresponding Chinese Patent Application No. 201880055689.4 and an English Translation of the Office Action. (15 pages). cited by applicant
English Translation of the International Search Report (Form PCT/ISA/210) and the Written Opinion of the International Searching Authority (Form PCT/ISA/237) issued on Dec. 4, 2018, by the Japan Patent Office in Corresponding International Application No. PCT/JP2018/035315. (6 pages). cited by applicant
International Search Report (with English translation) and Written Opinion issued in International Patent Application No. PCT/JP2018/035315 issued on Dec. 4, 2018. (7 pages). cited by applicant
The extended European Search Report issued on Jun. 9, 2020, by the European Patent Office in corresponding European Patent Application No. 18864930.5-1113. (31 pages). cited by applicant

Primary Examiner: Nguyen; Tuan V

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Buchanan Ingersoll & Rooney PC

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCES TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/831,029 filed on Mar. 26, 2020, which is a continuation of International Application No. PCT/JP2018/035315 filed on Sep. 25, 2018, which claims priority to Japanese Patent Application No. 2017-194059 filed on Oct. 4, 2017, the entire content of all three of which is incorporated herein by reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present disclosure generally relates to a medical device used to effectively destroy an object in a biological lumen, a method for controlling rotation of the medical device, and a rotation controller.

BACKGROUND DISCUSSION

(2) If a thrombus (i.e., blood clot) forms in a biological lumen, the thrombus should be removed promptly. As a symptom in which a thrombus is formed in a biological lumen, for example, deep vein thrombosis in which a thrombus is formed in a deep vein such as a femoral vein or a popliteal vein is exemplified. As a method for treating deep vein thrombosis, methods include inserting a long tubular body of a medical device into a blood vessel, injecting a drug such as a thrombolytic agent into an embolus (or a thrombus), and dissolving the thrombus to remove the thrombus.

(3) Treatment methods in which a drug is injected to remove a thrombus can involve side effects such as bleeding. For this reason, a treatment method has been proposed in which a member made of a wire provided at the distal portion of a shaft inserted into a blood vessel is rotated to mechanically destroy an embolus (thrombus or the like) with which the member comes in contact the to increase the patency rate (rate of a region that is not blocked to a cross section of the blood vessel) (for example, see U.S. Pat. No. 5,766,191). As a result, a drug is not necessary or the amount of drug can be reduced.

(4) When a thrombus in a lumen such as a blood vessel is destroyed by a rotating structure, the embolus from the thrombus floating in the lumen rotates together with the rotating structure. For this reason, it can be difficult to destroy the embolus floating in the lumen.

SUMMARY

(5) A medical device is disclosed that can effectively destroy an object in a biological lumen. In

addition, a method for controlling rotation of the medical device and a rotation controller are disclosed.

(6) In accordance with an aspect, a medical device is disclosed, which can be inserted into a biological lumen to effectively destroy an object in the biological lumen including a long shaft portion that is rotationally driven, a drive unit that rotates the shaft portion, a breaking member that is provided at a distal portion of the shaft portion and is rotatable, and a control unit that controls the rotation of the drive unit, in which the control unit controls the drive unit to repeat the rotation while interposing a stop of the rotation between rotations of the drive unit.

(7) In accordance with another aspect, a method is disclosed for controlling rotation of a medical device provided with a long shaft portion that is rotationally driven by a drive unit, and a breaking member provided at a distal portion of the shaft portion to destroy an object in a biological lumen, the method include rotating the shaft portion by the drive unit, stopping the rotation of the drive unit, and rotating the drive unit again.

(8) In accordance with a further aspect, a rotation controller of a medical device provided with a long shaft portion configured to be rotationally driven is disclosed, the rotation controller including a drive unit configured to rotate the shaft portion, and a control unit configured to control the rotation of the drive unit, in which the control unit controls the drive unit to repeat the rotation while interposing a stop of the rotation between rotations of the drive unit.

(9) A method is disclosed for destroying an object in a blood vessel and aspirating the destroyed object comprising: disposing a filter device downstream of the object in the blood vessel, the filter device including a filter and a wire portion connected to the filter; moving a breaking member of a medical device along the wire portion of the filter device to the object in the blood vessel, the medical device including the breaking member and an elongated shaft connected to the breaking member; rotating the breaking member in a first direction within the object in the blood vessel; stopping the rotation of the breaking member; rotating the breaking member in a second direction within the object in the blood vessel; and aspirating at least a portion of the object through an outer sheath of the medical device.

(10) A method is disclosed for treating an object in a biological lumen, the method comprising: disposing a filter device downstream of the object in the biological lumen, the filter device including a filter and a wire portion connected to the filter; moving a breaking member along the wire portion of the filter device to the object in the biological lumen, the breaking member being provided at a distal portion of an elongated shaft that is rotationally driven by a drive unit; rotating the breaking member in a first direction within the object in the biological lumen; stopping the rotation of the breaking member; and rotating the breaking member in a second direction within the object in the biological lumen.

(11) A method is disclosed for destroying an object in a blood vessel and aspirating the destroyed object comprising: providing a filter device comprising a filter and a wire portion connected to the filter, and a medical device comprising a breaking member configured to destroy the object in the blood vessel, an elongated shaft connected to the breaking member, and an outer sheath; disposing the filter device downstream of the object in the blood vessel: inserting the medical device onto the wire portion of the filter device; moving the breaking member of the medical device along the wire portion of the filter device to the object in the blood vessel; rotating the breaking member in a first direction; stopping the breaking member; rotating the breaking member in a second direction; and aspirating at least a portion the object from within the filter with the outer sheath.

(12) Since the medical device and the method for controlling the rotation of the medical device configured as described above rotate the breaking member while interposing a stop between rotations of the medical device, it is possible to effectively create a state in which the relative speed between the object and the breaking member, which rotate by receiving the force from the breaking member, is relatively large. Therefore, a high shear stress can be applied to the object to be destroyed by the breaking member, and the object can be rather effectively destroyed.

(13) The rotation controller of the medical device configured as described above can effectively create a state in which the relative speed between the shaft portion and an object that rotates by receiving a force from the shaft portion or a drug such as a thrombolytic agent is relatively large.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a plan view showing a medical device according to an embodiment.
- (2) FIG. 2 is a perspective view showing a breaking member of the medical device.
- (3) FIGS. 3A and 3B are graphs showing an operation of the medical device, wherein FIG. 3A shows rotation speed with respect to revolutions, and FIG. 3B shows a current supplied to a drive unit with respect to the revolutions.
- (4) FIG. 4 is a flowchart showing a method for controlling rotation of the medical device.
- (5) FIGS. 5A and 5B are cross-sectional views showing a state inside a blood vessel, wherein FIG. 5A shows a state in which the medical device is inserted into a blood vessel, and FIG. 5B shows a state in which the breaking member of the medical device is exposed in the blood vessel.
- (6) FIGS. 6A and 6B are cross-sectional views showing a state inside a blood vessel, wherein FIG. 6A shows a state in which a thrombus is destroyed by the breaking member in a contracted state, and FIG. 6B shows a state in which the thrombus is destroyed by the breaking member in an expanded state.
- (7) FIGS. 7A-7D are cross-sectional views showing the breaking member rotating in the thrombus, wherein FIG. 7A shows a state in which the breaking member is rotating, FIG. 7B shows a state in which where the breaking member is stopped, FIG. 7C shows a state in which the breaking member is rotating in the opposite direction, and FIG. 7D shows a state in which the breaking member is stopped again.
- (8) FIGS. 8A and 8B are cross-sectional views showing the breaking member rotating inside the thrombus, wherein FIG. 8A shows a state in which the breaking member is rotating in a protruding direction of a projection portion, and FIG. 8B shows a state in which the breaking member is expanded.
- (9) FIGS. 9A and 9B are cross-sectional views showing the breaking member rotating inside the thrombus, wherein FIG. 9A shows a state in which the breaking member is rotating in a direction opposite to the protruding direction of the projection portion, and FIG. 9B shows a state in which the breaking member is contracted.
- (10) FIGS. 10A and 10B are graphs showing another example of the operation of the medical device, wherein FIG. 10A shows rotation speed with respect to revolutions, and FIG. 10B shows a current supplied to a drive unit with respect to the revolutions.
- (11) FIGS. 11A and 11B are graphs showing still another example of the operation of the medical device, wherein FIG. 11A shows rotation speed with respect to revolutions, and FIG. 11B shows a current supplied to a drive unit with respect to the revolutions.
- (12) FIGS. 12A and 12B are graphs showing still another example of the operation of the medical device, wherein FIG. 12A shows rotation speed with respect to revolutions, and FIG. 12B shows a current supplied to a drive unit with respect to the revolutions.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(13) Set forth below with reference to the accompanying drawings is a detailed description of embodiments of a medical device used to effectively destroy an object in a biological lumen, a method for controlling rotation of the medical device, and a rotation controller representing examples of the inventive medical device used to destroy an object in a biological lumen, the method for controlling rotation of the medical device, and the rotation controller. The dimensions or scales on the drawings may be exaggerated or different from actuality/reality for convenience of

description and illustration.

(14) A medical device **10** according to the present embodiment is inserted into a blood vessel in deep vein thrombosis, and is used for a treatment for destroying and removing a thrombus. In the present specification, the side of the device to be inserted into a blood vessel is referred to as “distal side”, and the hand-side for operation is referred to as “proximal side”. Note that, the object to be removed is not necessarily limited to a thrombus, and may be any object that can be present in a biological lumen.

(15) As shown in FIG. **1**, the medical device **10** includes a long shaft portion **20** that is rotationally driven, an outer sheath **90** that can accommodate the shaft portion **20**, a slide portion **50** that can slide with respect to the shaft portion **20**, and a breaking member **60** that is rotated by the shaft portion **20**. The medical device **10** further includes a rotation operation unit **70** for rotating the shaft portion **20**, a guide wire tubular body **40** into which a guide wire can be inserted, and a hub **80** provided at a proximal end portion of the guide wire tubular body **40**.

(16) The proximal end portion of the shaft portion **20** is located in the rotation operation unit **70**. The shaft portion **20** can be reciprocated (i.e., rotates in one direction and then rotates in an opposite direction) along the circumferential direction by the rotation operation unit **70**. However, the shaft portion **20** is not limited to the one that reciprocates, and may be one that rotates in one direction.

(17) The guide wire tubular body **40** is provided in the hollow interior of the shaft portion **20** from the distal end portion to the hub **80**. The guide wire tubular body **40** has a guide wire lumen into which a guide wire can be inserted.

(18) The outer sheath **90** is disposed coaxially outside the shaft portion **20**. The lumen of the outer sheath **90** not only accommodates the breaking member **60**, but also has a function as an aspiration lumen that generates an aspiration force when in a negative pressure state. The proximal end portion of the outer sheath **90** branches into a Y-shape. In one of the branches, the shaft portion **20** extends to the rotation operation unit **70**. The other branch is a bypass **91** to which a syringe **120** can be connected. By connecting the syringe **120**, the lumen of the outer sheath **90** can be aspirated and brought into a negative pressure state. Further, by connecting the syringe **120** to the bypass **91**, for example, a thrombolytic agent can be injected from the syringe **120** into the lumen of the outer sheath **90**.

(19) The breaking member **60** is provided at a distal portion of the shaft portion **20**. The breaking member **60** includes a plurality of (for example, six (6) wires in the present embodiment) wires **61**. Each wire **61** is three-dimensionally curved (i.e., having a three-dimensional shape). Note that, the number of wires **61** is not particularly limited. Each wire **61** is twisted in the same circumferential direction along the axial direction of the shaft portion **20**. The proximal end portion of each wire **61** is fixed to the slide portion **50**, and wherein the slide portion **50** is slidable with respect to the shaft portion **20**. The distal end portion of each wire **61** is fixed to a fixing portion **51** and wherein the fixing portion **51** is fixed to the shaft portion **20**. The fixing positions of the respective wires **61** with respect to the fixing portion **51** and the slide portion **50** are arranged in the circumferential direction. Further, the substantial center portions of the wires **61** in the axial direction in which the wires curve are arranged in the circumferential direction at a position away from the shaft portion **20** in the radial direction. Accordingly, an entirety of the breaking member **60** can be uniformly expanded in the circumferential direction. When the shaft portion **20** rotates, the breaking member **60** rotates along with the shaft portion. Therefore, it is possible to break a thrombus in a blood vessel or agitate the broken thrombus (i.e., embolism). Each wire **61** has a projection portion **63** that is three-dimensionally curved and protrudes radially outward when viewed from the front surface and on the same side in the circumferential direction (i.e., the shape of each wire when viewed from the front surface is the same). Note that, each wire **61** may not have the projection portion **63**. The breaking means, for example, crushing an object with a structure, and the shape of the structure, the method of crushing, the degree of crushing, the range to be crushed, the shape of

the crushed object, and the like are not limited.

(20) The wire **61** constituting the breaking member **60** can be formed of a relatively flexible thin metal wire. In accordance with an embodiment, the breaking member **60** is housed inside the outer sheath **90** until the shaft portion **20** is inserted into a target site. When accommodating the wire **61** in the outer sheath **90**, the outer sheath **90** is moved to the distal side with respect to the shaft portion **20**, and the distal end portion of the outer sheath **90** is pressed against the proximal portion of the breaking member **60**. Accordingly, the slide portion **50** moves to the proximal side along the shaft portion **20**, and the wire **61** is reduced in diameter and accommodated inside the outer sheath **90**. When the outer sheath **90** is moved to the proximal side with respect to the shaft portion **20** after inserting the shaft portion **20** to a target site in the blood vessel, the breaking member **60** is exposed outside the outer sheath **90** and expands by its own elastic force. At this time, the slide portion **50** moves to the distal side along the shaft portion **20**.

(21) The wire(s) **61** of the breaking member **60** is preferably made of a material having shape memory so that it can be elastically deformed. The constituent material of the wire **61** is preferably, for example, a shape memory alloy to which a shape memory effect or superelasticity is imparted by heat treatment, stainless steel, or the like. As the shape memory alloy, a Ni—Ti based alloy, a Cu—Al—Ni based alloy, a Cu—Zn—Al based alloy, or a combination of a Ni—Ti based alloy, a Cu—Al—Ni based alloy, and/or a Cu—Zn—Al based alloy is suitable.

(22) The rotation operation unit **70** includes, as shown in FIG. 1, a drive unit **71** (i.e., a motor) connected to a power supply, a gear unit **72** that links the drive unit **71** with the shaft portion **20**, a tachometer **73**, and a switch **74**. The switch **74** is a part for turning the operation of the drive unit **71** on or off. By rotating the drive unit **71**, the shaft portion **20** rotates in the circumferential direction. The tachometer **73** measures the rotation speed of the shaft portion **20**. The power supply connected to the drive unit **71** can be, for example, a facility power supply or a battery. The gear ratio of the gear unit **72** can be appropriately set.

(23) The control unit **100** controls the rotation of the drive unit **71**. The control unit **100** includes a central processing unit (CPU) and a storage circuit, and is connected to the drive unit **71**. The control unit **100** may be connected to an interface such as a keyboard, a mouse, and a monitor. The control unit **100** can be, for example, a computer or a dedicated device. The storage circuit stores a program executed by the control unit **100** and various parameters.

(24) The control unit **100** controls the current supplied to the drive unit **71** so that the breaking member **60** has a predetermined rotation speed. The control unit **100** receives a signal indicating the rotation speed of the shaft portion **20** from the tachometer **73**. Note that, the control unit **100** may receive a signal indicating the rotation speed of the drive unit **71** from the drive unit **71** and convert the signal into the rotation speed of the shaft portion **20**.

(25) As shown in FIG. 3A, the control unit **100** controls the current C input to the drive unit **71** such that the rotation speed S of the shaft portion **20** coincides with the target rotation speed T . The target rotation speed T is set in advance and stored in the storage circuit. The absolute value of the target rotation speed T with respect to the revolutions of the shaft portion **20** is constant in the present embodiment, but may be changed. The value of the current C input to the drive unit **71** with respect to the revolutions is controlled and changed by the control unit **100** as shown in FIG. 3B. Note that, the revolutions of the shaft portion **20**, which is the horizontal axis of the graph shown in FIGS. 3A and 3B, is a value added according to the rotation without distinction (no distinction between positive and negative) of the rotation direction. The control unit **100** rotates the drive unit **71** such that the shaft portion **20** and the breaking member **60** rotate alternately in the positive and negative circumferential directions. Note that, the current C input to the drive unit **71** is proportional to the rotational force (torque) generated by the drive unit **71**.

(26) The rotation operation unit **70** and the control unit **100** constitute a rotation controller **101** as shown in FIG. 1. The rotation operation unit **70** and the control unit **100** may be integrally formed in the same housing. Alternatively, the rotation operation unit **70** and the control unit **100** may be

configured separately in different housings.

(27) Next, a method of controlling the rotation of the medical device **10** according to the embodiment will be described as an example of a case where a thrombus in a blood vessel is destroyed and aspirated with reference to the flowchart shown in FIG. 4.

(28) Before inserting the shaft portion **20** of the medical device **10** according to the embodiment, it is desirable that a protective member such as a filter or a balloon that restricts the flow of fluid in the blood vessel be disposed downstream of the thrombus B in the blood vessel (the side to which blood flow is directed). In the present embodiment, as shown in FIG. 5A, a filter device **110** is used which includes an elastic body **111** made of a wire that expands by its own elastic force by being pushed out from a sheath or the like, a mesh-like or membrane-like filter **112** disposed on the outer peripheral surface of the elastic body **111**, and a wire portion **113** interlocked with the elastic body **111**. When the elastic body **111** pushed out from the sheath or the like expands and the filter **112** comes into contact with a blood vessel, the filter **112** restricts blood flow. Accordingly, the destroyed thrombus B can be prevented from flowing in the blood vessel and moving to another location.

(29) Next, the medical device **10** in a state in which the distal portion of the shaft portion **20** including the breaking member **60** is housed in the outer sheath **90** is prepared. Next, the proximal end portion of the wire portion **113** is inserted into the guide wire lumen of the guide wire tubular body **40** of the medical device **10**. Next, the medical device **10** is caused to reach the distal side of the thrombus B using the wire portion **113** as a guide. Thereafter, when the outer sheath **90** is moved to the proximal side with respect to the shaft portion **20**, as shown in FIG. 5B, the breaking member **60** is exposed to the outside of the outer sheath **90**, and expands by its own elastic force. At this time, the slide portion **50** moves to the distal side with respect to the shaft portion **20**.

(30) Next, in a state in which the breaking member **60** is in contact with or close to the thrombus B, the rotation operation unit **70** (see FIG. 1) is operated (step S10). Accordingly, the control unit **100** determines the rotation direction of the drive unit **71** (step S11), and rotates the drive unit **71**. Note that, for example, the direction in which the shaft portion **20** is rotated first is the positive direction. The positive and negative in the rotation direction can be reversed. As shown in FIG. 3A, the control unit **100** gradually accelerates the shaft portion **20** and the breaking member **60** driven by the drive unit **71** (step S12). The target rotation speed T is not particularly limited, but is, for example, 2000 rpm (revolutions per minute) to 3200 rpm. When the rotation speed S of the shaft portion **20** reaches the target rotation speed T (step S13), the control unit **100** maintains the rotation speed S of the shaft portion **20** (step S14). The control unit **100** controls the current C input to the drive unit **71** to maintain the target rotation speed T. Since the breaking member **60** that has reached the target rotation speed T has a relatively high speed, it can rather effectively break the thrombus B (i.e., blood clot) stuck to the blood vessel and the thrombus B (i.e., embolism) floating in the blood vessel. Therefore, it is preferable that there is a time during which the breaking member **60** rotates at the target rotation speed T. Note that, it is possible that the breaking member **60** does not reach the target rotation speed T and does not have time rotated at the target rotation speed T.

(31) In order to cause the shaft portion **20** and the breaking member **60** to reach the target rotation speed T as quickly as possible, the control unit **100** may set the current C input to the drive unit **71** high at the beginning of rotation as shown in FIG. 3B. When the breaking member **60** rotates in the blood vessel, the breaking member **60** breaks the thrombus B. As shown in FIGS. 6A and 6B, the blood in the blood vessel and the broken thrombus B receive force from the breaking member **60** and rotate. Therefore, the rotation speed of the blood and the thrombus B in the blood vessel rises later than the rotation speed S of the breaking member **60**.

(32) When the rotation speed S of the breaking member **60** becomes substantially constant at the target rotation speed T, the blood that is rotated by the force from the breaking member **60** and the broken thrombus B gradually approach the rotation speed S of the breaking member **60**, and substantially coincide with each other. That is, the control unit **100** maintains the rotation speed S

of the breaking member **60** constant until the rotation speed of the blood and the broken thrombus B substantially coincides with the rotation speed S of the breaking member **60**. As the rotation speed of the blood and the broken thrombus B reaches the rotation speed S of the breaking member **60**, when the breaking member **60** subsequently rotates in the reverse direction, the relative speeds of the breaking member **60**, blood, and the broken thrombus B increase. Therefore, the breaking member **60** can break the thrombus B rather effectively.

(33) When the rotation speed S of the breaking member **60** and the rotation speed of the thrombus B substantially coincide with each other, the thrombus B rotates together with the breaking member **60**. Therefore, the breaking member **60** cannot break the thrombus B floating in the blood vessel. Therefore, it is preferable that the rotation of the breaking member **60** be stopped immediately after the rotation speed S of the breaking member **60** and the rotation speed of the thrombus B substantially coincide with each other. The revolutions of the shaft portion **20** and the breaking member **60** in a state in which the rotation speed S of the breaking member **60** and the rotation speed of the thrombus B are substantially the same is not particularly limited, but is preferably, for example, 1 rotation to 5 rotations.

(34) Note that, the condition that the rotation speed S of the breaking member **60** and the rotation speed of the thrombus B are considered to be substantially the same can be set by the rotation angle (revolutions) of the shaft portion **20** and the breaking member **60**. For example, when the rotation angle of the shaft portion **20** reaches a predetermined upper limit value (for example, 2880 degrees (8 rotations)) (step S15), the control unit **100** stops the current C supplied to the drive unit **71**, and stops the rotation of the drive unit **71** (step S16). Accordingly, as shown in FIG. 3A, the rotation speed S of the shaft portion **20** and the breaking member **60** decreases and becomes zero. It is preferable that the rotation of the shaft portion **20** and the breaking member **60** be stopped promptly so that the rotation can be quickly reversed. By rapidly rotating the breaking member **60** in the reverse direction, the relative speed between the breaking member **60** and the thrombus B increases, and the thrombus B can be broken effectively. The time required for the rotation of the breaking member **60** to stop from the target rotation speed T is preferably shorter than the time required for the rotation of the breaking member **60** to reach the target rotation speed T after the rotation of the breaking member **60** has stopped, but is not limited to this. For example, the rotation speed S of the breaking member **60** may gradually decrease.

(35) When the rotation speed of the blood and the broken thrombus B substantially coincides with the rotation speed S of the breaking member **60**, the speed becomes a steady state, and the current C input to the drive unit **71** does not change and becomes substantially constant. Therefore, when the current C input to the drive unit **71** is substantially constant, it can be determined that the rotation speed of the blood and the broken thrombus B substantially coincides with the rotation speed S of the breaking member **60**.

(36) The upper limit value of the rotation angle (revolutions) at which the shaft portion **20** and the breaking member **60** are continuously rotated in the same direction, for example, is preferably 720 degrees (2 rotations) or more, more preferably 2880 degrees (8 rotations) or more, still more preferably 5760 degrees (16 rotations) or more. The rotation angle (revolutions) required for the rotation speed S to reach the target rotation speed T from zero is not particularly limited, but is, for example, 2160 (6 rotations). The rotation angle (revolutions) at which the breaking member **60** reaches the target rotation speed T and rotates while being maintained at the target rotation speed T is not particularly limited, but is, for example, 720 degrees (2 rotations).

(37) The breaking member **60** located at the distal portion of the shaft portion **20** has a phase of rotation delayed with respect to the rotation of the drive unit **71** due to the twist of the shaft portion **20**. Therefore, after the rotation of the drive unit **71** stops, a predetermined time is required until the rotation of the breaking member **60** stops. Therefore, by providing a stop time during which the rotation of the drive unit **71** is stopped by the control unit **100**, the twist of the shaft portion **20** is released, and the breaking member **60** can be restored to a state desired for breaking. Therefore, it

is preferable that the stop time of the drive unit **71** is equal to or longer than the time during which the twist of the shaft portion **20** returns. The stop time of the drive unit **71** is preferably shorter than the time required for the rotation of the blood and thrombus B generated by the breaking member **60** in the blood vessel to stop. Accordingly, when the rotation of the shaft portion **20** and the breaking member **60** is resumed, the blood and the thrombus B do not stop and continue to rotate due to the inertial force. Therefore, the relative speed between the breaking member **60** and the floating thrombus B increases, and the breaking member **60** can effectively break the thrombus B. The stop time of the drive unit **71** can be, for example, 0.25 seconds to 0.5 seconds, but is not limited to this, depending on the structure of the shaft portion **20** and the breaking member **60**.

(38) Note that, the stop time of the drive unit **71** may be shorter than the time in which the twist of the shaft portion **20** returns. Further, the stop time of the drive unit **71** may not be provided. In these cases, before the twist of the shaft portion **20** returns, the proximal portion of the shaft portion **20** is driven by the drive unit **71** and starts to rotate in the opposite direction. After the proximal portion of the shaft portion **20** starts to rotate, the breaking member **60** located at the distal portion of the shaft portion **20** changes its rotational direction a predetermined time later, and starts to rotate in the same direction as the proximal portion of the shaft portion **20**.

(39) When the stop time of the drive unit **71** elapses (step **S17**), the control unit **100** determines whether the switch **74** is on or off (step **S10**). If the switch **74** is maintained on, the control unit **100** determines the rotation direction of the drive unit **71** (step **S11**). The control unit **100** sets the rotation direction of the drive unit **71** to the direction opposite to the rotation direction of the drive unit **71** before the drive unit **71** stops, as shown in FIG. 3A. The control unit **100** gradually accelerates the shaft portion **20** and the breaking member **60** driven by the drive unit **71** to reach the target rotation speed T whose positive and negative direction is opposite to that of the rotation before the stop (step **S12**). At this time, as shown in FIG. 3B, the current C also has a positive and negative polarity with respect to the case of rotation before the stop. When the breaking member **60** rotates in the blood vessel, the breaking member **60** breaks the thrombus B, as shown in FIGS. 6A and 6B. The blood in the blood vessel and the broken thrombus B receive rotational force from the breaking member **60**. At this time, the blood and thrombus B continue to rotate in the positive direction due to the inertial force due to the rotation in the positive direction before the breaking member **60** rotates in the negative direction. Moreover, the rotation speeds of the blood and the thrombus B are accelerated by the breaking member **60** rotating in the positive direction until they substantially coincide with the rotation speed S of the breaking member **60**. Therefore, when the breaking member **60** rotates in the opposite direction, the relative difference between the rotation speed S of the breaking member **60** and the rotation speeds of blood and thrombus B increases. Therefore, the shear force acting on the thrombus B floating in the blood vessel is increased by the breaking member **60**. Therefore, the thrombus B can be effectively broken by the breaking member **60**. When the breaking member **60** rotates in the opposite direction, the maximum shear stress acting between the breaking member **60** and the floating thrombus B can be, for example, 1300 Pa to 3000 Pa, but is not limited to 1300 Pa to 3000 Pa. Thereafter, similarly to the above-described control in the positive direction, when the rotation speed S of the shaft portion **20** reaches the target rotation speed T (step **S13**), the control unit **100** maintains the rotation speed S of the shaft portion **20** (step **S14**). Then, when the rotation angle of the shaft portion **20** reaches the predetermined upper limit value (step **S15**), the control unit **100** stops the current C supplied to the drive unit **71**, and stops the rotation of the drive unit **71** (step **S16**). Next, when the stop time of the drive unit **71** has elapsed (step **S17**), the control unit **100** returns to the determination of whether the switch **74** is on or off (step **S10**). Then, as long as switch **74** is maintained on, control unit **100** repeats steps **S10** to **S17** while changing the rotation direction of drive unit **71**. When the switch **74** is turned off by the technician, the control unit **100** maintains the rotation of the drive unit **71** in a stopped state, and ends the control (step **S10**).

(40) During the operation of the medical device **10**, as shown in FIG. 7A, when the rotation is

stopped or the speed is reduced to change the rotation direction, the reaction force that the wires **61** receive from the thrombus B decreases. Therefore, the wires **61** spread, and the wires **61** bite into the thrombus B as shown in FIG. 7B. Thereafter, when the wires **61** rotate while being bitten by the thrombus B, the wires **61** scrape the thrombus B, and the thrombus B attached to the blood vessel can be effectively broken, as shown in FIGS. 7C and 7D. The breaking member **60** repeats the operation of biting into the thrombus B when stopped and scraping the thrombus B by the rotation by repeating the rotation and the stop. Accordingly, the breaking member **60** can scrape a large amount of thrombus B rather quickly.

(41) Further, since the projection portion **63** protrudes in the circumferential direction (rotation direction), when the projection portion **63** rotates in the protruding direction as shown in FIG. 8A, the breaking member **60** bites into the thrombus B while expanding as shown in FIG. 8B. By biting, a large amount of thrombus B can be scraped off. Further, since the projection portion **63** protrudes in the circumferential direction (rotation direction), as shown in FIG. 9A, when rotated in the direction opposite to the protruding direction, the breaking member **60** contracts as shown in FIG. 9B. Accordingly, the projection portion **63** can be rather easily separated from the thrombus B, and the breaking member **60** can be rather easily moved in the axial direction. In this way, by repeating the reciprocating rotation of the breaking member **60**, it becomes possible to effectively repeat the scraping of the thrombus B and the movement in the axial direction.

(42) By repeatedly reciprocating the breaking member **60** in the axial direction by hand operation while repeating reciprocating rotation of the breaking member **60** by the control unit **100**, the thrombus B floating in the blood vessel can be finely broken while the thrombus B attached to the blood vessel is scraped off by the breaking member **60**.

(43) When the breaking member **60** is rotated and moved in the axial direction in order to break the thrombus B, the syringe **120** accommodating a thrombolytic agent can be connected to the bypass **91** on the hand-side of the outer sheath **90**. Then, simultaneously with the destruction of the thrombus B by the breaking member **60**, the plunger of the syringe **120** can be pressed to eject the thrombolytic agent from the distal end portion of the outer sheath **90**. The ejection of the thrombolytic agent may be, for example, continuous or intermittent, and the ejection speed and the ejection amount can be desirably changed. In the case where the thrombolytic agent is ejected intermittently, it is possible to aspirate while the ejection is stopped.

(44) By ejecting the thrombolytic agent at the same time as the thrombus B is broken by the breaking member **60**, the thrombolytic agent can be rather efficiently soaked into the gap between the thrombus B generated by the breaking effect of the breaking member **60**. Therefore, it is possible to soften the thrombus B before destruction, or to reduce the volume of the thrombus B by dissolution. Further, dissolving the broken thrombus B also has the effect of reducing the amount of aspiration for discharging the thrombus B later.

(45) The destroyed thrombus B is stopped by the filter device **110**. Thereafter, the plunger of the syringe **120** for aspiration (see FIG. 1) is pulled to bring the inside of the outer sheath **90** into a negative pressure state. Accordingly, the destroyed thrombus B can be aspirated from the opening portion on the distal side of the outer sheath **90** and discharged to the syringe **120** outside the blood vessel.

(46) The aspiration of the thrombus B can be performed either during the rotation of the shaft portion **20** or after the rotation is stopped. After the aspiration of the thrombus B and the stop of the rotation of the shaft portion **20**, the breaking member **60** is accommodated in the outer sheath **90**, and the medical device **10** is removed from the blood vessel. Thereafter, the filter device **110** is accommodated in a sheath or the like and removed from the blood vessel, and the treatment is completed.

(47) As described above, the medical device **10** according to the embodiment is a device that is inserted into the biological lumen for destroying the thrombus B (object) of the biological lumen, includes a long shaft portion **20** that is rotationally driven, a drive unit **71** that rotates the shaft

portion **20**, a breaking member **60** that is provided at a distal portion of the shaft portion **20** and is rotatable, and a control unit **100** that controls the rotation of the drive unit **71**, in which the control unit **100** controls the drive unit **71** to repeat the rotation while interposing a stop of the rotation between the rotations.

(48) The medical device **10** configured as described above rotates the breaking member **60** while interposing a stop between the rotations. Therefore, it is possible to effectively create a state in which the relative speed between the thrombus B and the breaking member **60**, which rotate by receiving the force from the breaking member **60**, is large. Therefore, a high shearing stress can be applied to the thrombus B to be destroyed by the breaking member **60**, and the thrombus B can be rather effectively broken.

(49) Further, when stopping and rotating the drive unit **71** again, the control unit **100** rotates the drive unit **71** in a direction opposite to the rotation direction before the stop. Accordingly, the relative speed of the thrombus B, which continues to rotate by the inertial force receiving the force from the breaking member **60** before the stop and the breaking member **60** rotating in the opposite direction after the stop, increases. Therefore, the thrombus B can be effectively destroyed by the breaking member **60**.

(50) Further, when rotating the drive unit **71** in the opposite direction, the control unit **100** rotates the drive unit **71** at the same rotation angle as a rotation angle of the previous rotation. Accordingly, the thrombus B is prevented from being entangled with the breaking member **60**, and the breaking effect can be maintained satisfactorily. Note that, the rotation angles before and after the stop do not have to completely coincide with each other, and may have some fluctuation. The fluctuation of the rotation angle can be, for example, preferably 180 degrees or less, more preferably 90 degrees or less, and further preferably 30 degrees or less.

(51) Further, after stopping the rotation of the drive unit **71**, the control unit **100** stops the rotation of the drive unit **71** for a predetermined time. Accordingly, by providing a stop time during which the rotation of the drive unit **71** is stopped, the twist of the shaft portion **20** is released, and the breaking member **60** can be restored to a state desired for breaking.

(52) Further, the control unit **100** continues the rotation of the drive unit **71** in the same direction for 720 degrees (2 rotations) or more. This facilitates rotation of the broken thrombus B following the breaking member **60**. Therefore, when the breaking member **60** rotates again after the stop, the relative speed between the thrombus B, which rotates receiving the force from the breaking member **60** and the breaking member **60**, increases. Therefore, the thrombus B can be effectively destroyed by the breaking member **60**.

(53) Further, the breaking member **60** has the projection portion **63** that is bent in a convex shape radially outward and toward the rotation direction. Accordingly, the projection portion **63** bites into the thrombus B by rotating in the direction in which the projection portion **63** faces, and expands its diameter. By rotating in the opposite direction, the bite of the breaking member **60** is loosened and the diameter of the breaking member **60** is reduced. Therefore, it is possible to effectively repeat the scraping of the thrombus B and the movement of the breaking member **60** in the circumferential and axial directions.

(54) Further, the method for controlling the rotation of the medical device **10** according to the embodiment provided with a long shaft portion **20** that is rotationally driven by a drive unit **71**, and a breaking member **60** provided at a distal portion of the shaft portion **20** to destroy a thrombus B (object) in a biological lumen, the method for controlling the rotation of the medical device **10** includes rotating the shaft portion **20** by the drive unit **71**, stopping the rotation of the drive unit **71**, and rotating the drive unit **71** again.

(55) In the method of controlling the rotation of the medical device **10** configured as described above, the breaking member **60** is rotated while interposing a stop between the rotations. Therefore, it is possible to effectively create a state in which the relative speed between the thrombus B and the breaking member **60**, which rotate by receiving the force from the breaking member **60**, is

relatively large. Therefore, a high shearing stress can be applied to the thrombus B to be destroyed by the breaking member **60**, and the thrombus B can be rather effectively broken.

(56) Further, in the present method for controlling the rotation, in the rotation of the drive unit **71** again, the drive unit **71** is rotated in a direction opposite to the rotation direction of the drive unit **71** before the stop. Accordingly, the relative speed of the thrombus B, which continues to rotate by the inertial force receiving the force from the breaking member **60** before the stop and the breaking member **60** rotating in the opposite direction after the stop, increases. Therefore, the thrombus B can be rather effectively destroyed by the breaking member **60**.

(57) Further, in the present method for controlling the rotation, in the rotation of the drive unit **71** again, the drive unit **71** is rotated at the same rotation angle as the rotation angle of the previous rotation. Accordingly, the thrombus B is prevented from being entangled with the breaking member **60**, and the breaking effect can be satisfactorily maintained.

(58) Further, in the present method for controlling the rotation, after stopping the rotation of the drive unit **71**, the rotation of the drive unit **71** is stopped for a predetermined time. Accordingly, by providing a stop time during which the rotation of the drive unit **71** is stopped, the twist of the shaft portion **20** is released, and the breaking member **60** can be restored to a state desired for breaking.

(59) Further, in the present method for controlling the rotation, the rotation of the drive unit **71** is continued in the same direction for 720 degrees (2 rotations) or more, which facilitates rotation of the broken thrombus B following the breaking member **60**. Therefore, when the breaking member **60** rotates again after the stop, the relative speed between the thrombus B, which rotates receiving the force from the breaking member **60** and the breaking member **60**, increases. Therefore, the thrombus B can be rather effectively destroyed by the breaking member **60**.

(60) Further, the present disclosure also provides a procedure method (treatment method) for destroying thrombus B (object) in a biological lumen using the medical device **10** described above. The method is a procedure method for destroying thrombus B in a biological lumen using the medical device **10** provided with a long shaft portion **20** that is rotationally driven by a drive unit **71** and a breaking member **60** provided at a distal portion of the shaft portion **20** to destroy a thrombus B in a biological lumen, the method including delivering the breaking member **60** to the vicinity of the thrombus B by inserting the shaft portion **20** into the biological lumen, rotating the breaking member **60** to destroy the thrombus B while creating a circumferential flow in the biological lumen, stopping the rotation of the breaking member **60**, and rotating the breaking member **60** again to destroy the thrombus B while creating a flow in the circumferential direction in the biological lumen.

(61) In the procedure method configured as described above, the breaking member **60** is rotated while interposing a stop between the rotations. Therefore, it is possible to effectively create a state in which the relative speed between the thrombus B which rotates by receiving the force from the breaking member **60** and the breaking member **60**, is relatively large. Therefore, a high shearing stress can be applied to the thrombus B to be destroyed by the breaking member **60**, and the thrombus B can be rather effectively broken.

(62) Further, in the present procedure method, the direction in which the breaking member **60** is rotated again is the opposite direction to the rotation direction before stopping the rotation of the breaking member **60**. Accordingly, the relative speed of the thrombus B, which continues to rotate by the inertial force, receiving the force from the breaking member **60** before the stop, and the breaking member **60** rotating in the opposite direction after the stop, increases. Therefore, the thrombus B can be effectively destroyed by the breaking member **60**.

(63) Further, the present disclosure also provides a rotation controller **101** of the medical device **10**. The rotation controller **101** is a rotation controller **101** of the medical device **10** provided with the long shaft portion **20** that is rotationally driven, and includes a drive unit **71** that rotates the shaft portion **20**, and a control unit **100** that controls the rotation of the drive unit **71**, in which the control unit **100** controls the drive unit **71** to repeat the rotation while interposing a stop of the rotation

between the rotations.

(64) The rotation controller **101** of the medical device **10** configured as described above can effectively create a state in which the relative speed between the drug such as a thrombolytic agent that rotates by receiving a force from the shaft portion **20** and the shaft portion **20** is relatively large. Therefore, it is possible to create a flow of the drug and enhance the effect of the drug. Further, when the breaking member **60** is fixed to the shaft portion **20**, the rotation controller **101** can rather effectively create a state in which the relative speed between the thrombus B, which rotates by receiving a force from the breaking member **60**, and the breaking member **60** is relatively large. Therefore, the thrombus B can be rather effectively destroyed by the breaking member **60**.

(65) Note that, the present disclosure is not limited to only the above-described embodiments, and various modifications can be made by those skilled in the art within the technical idea of the present disclosure. For example, the biological lumen into which the medical device is inserted is not limited to a blood vessel, and may be, for example, a vessel, a ureter, a bile duct, a fallopian tube, a hepatic duct, or the like. Therefore, the object to be destroyed need not be a thrombus.

(66) Further, as shown in FIGS. **10A** and **10B**, when stopping the rotation of the drive unit **71**, the control unit **100** may apply the current C_0 (i.e., a constant current) for generating a rotational force in a direction opposite to the rotation direction to the drive unit **71**. Accordingly, the rotation of the breaking member **60** can be rapidly changed, and a state in which the relative speed between the floating thrombus B and the breaking member **60** is large can be effectively created. Therefore, the thrombus B can be rather effectively destroyed by the breaking member **60**.

(67) Further, as shown in FIGS. **11A** and **11B**, the rotation speed S may not reach the target rotation speed T . In this case, for example, the number of times of reversing the rotation of the breaking member **60** within a predetermined time can be increased. Therefore, the thrombus B can be effectively destroyed even if the rotation speed S does not reach the target rotation speed T .

(68) Further, as shown in FIGS. **12A** and **12B**, the rotation directions of the drive unit **71**, the shaft portion **20**, and the breaking member **60** may be the same direction instead of the opposite direction with the stop interposed between the rotations. Even in this case, by stopping the rotation of the breaking member **60**, the relative speed between the breaking member **60** and the blood and the thrombus B that is broken and floats can be increased. Therefore, the breaking member **60** can effectively destroy the thrombus B.

(69) Further, the wire constituting the breaking member **60** may not be spiral, and may be linear in the axial direction in a circumferential development, for example.

(70) Further, in the present embodiment, the proximal portion of the breaking member **60** can be fixed to the slide portion **50** that can slide with respect to the shaft portion **20**, and the distal portion of the breaking member **60** may be fixed to a slide portion slidable with respect to the shaft portion **20**.

(71) Further, the control unit **100** may control the value of the current C without specifying the rotation speed S by detection or conversion. By controlling the current C to a value set in advance to obtain a desired rotation speed S , the rotation speed S can be kept within a predetermined range without specifying the rotation speed S .

(72) The detailed description above describes embodiments of a medical device used to destroy an object in a biological lumen, a method for controlling rotation of the medical device, and a rotation controller. The invention is not limited, however, to the precise embodiments and variations described. Various changes, modifications and equivalents may occur to one skilled in the art without departing from the spirit and scope of the invention as defined in the accompanying claims. It is expressly intended that all such changes, modifications and equivalents which fall within the scope of the claims are embraced by the claims.

Claims

1. A method for destroying an object in a blood vessel and aspirating the destroyed object comprising: disposing a filter device downstream of the object in the blood vessel, the filter device including a filter and a wire portion connected to the filter; moving a breaking member of a medical device along the wire portion of the filter device to the object in the blood vessel, the medical device including the breaking member and an elongated shaft connected to the breaking member, the elongated shaft and the breaking member being rotated by a drive unit; rotating the breaking member in a first direction within the object in the blood vessel; stopping the rotation of the breaking member; rotating the breaking member in a second direction within the object in the blood vessel; interposing a stop of the rotation of the elongated shaft and the breaking member with a control unit in communication with the drive unit; stopping a rotation of the drive unit for a predetermined time to interpose the stopping of the rotation of the elongated shaft and the breaking member within the blood vessel; and aspirating at least a portion of the object through an outer sheath of the medical device.
2. The method according to claim 1, further comprising: rotating the elongated shaft along with the breaking member.
3. The method according to claim 1, further comprising: destroying the object in the blood vessel by the rotating of the breaking member in the first direction and the rotating of the breaking member in the second direction.
4. The method according to claim 1, further comprising: rotating the drive unit in a direction opposite to a rotational direction after the stopping of the rotation of the drive unit for the predetermined time.
5. The method according to claim 1, further comprising: rotating the drive unit at the same rotation angle as a rotational angle of a previous rotation after the stopping of the rotation of the drive unit for the predetermined time.
6. The method according to claim 1, further comprising: applying a current for generating a rotational force in a direction opposite to a rotational direction to the drive unit when stopping the rotation of the drive unit.
7. The method according to claim 1, further comprising: restoring the breaking member to a desired state for breaking by releasing twist of the elongated shaft with the stopping of the rotation of the drive unit for the predetermined time.
8. The method according to claim 1, further comprising: providing the breaking member with a projection portion that is bent in a convex shape radially outward and toward a rotational direction of the breaking member.
9. The method according to claim 1, further comprising: providing the rotatable breaking member at a distal portion of the elongated shaft.
10. A method for treating an object in a biological lumen, the method comprising: disposing a filter device downstream of the object in the biological lumen, the filter device including a filter and a wire portion connected to the filter; moving a breaking member along the wire portion of the filter device to the object in the biological lumen, the breaking member being provided at a distal portion of an elongated shaft that is rotationally driven by a drive unit; rotating the breaking member in a first direction within the object in the biological lumen; stopping the rotation of the breaking member for a predetermined time within the object in the biological lumen; and rotating the breaking member in a second direction within the object in the biological lumen.
11. The method according to claim 10, further comprising: aspirating at least a portion of the object through an outer sheath that accommodates the elongated shaft.
12. The method according to claim 10, further comprising: stopping the rotation of the breaking member for the predetermined time in order to release twist of the elongated shaft and restore the

breaking member to a desired state for breaking of the object within the biological lumen.

13. The method according to claim 10, wherein the breaking member includes an expanded state and a contracted state, the method comprises: contacting the object in the biological lumen with the breaking member in one or more of the contracted state and the expanded state.
